



PATHWAY TO BECOMING AN AIR FORCE PILOT

-OFFICER TRAINING AND COMPETETNG FOR FLIGHT SCHOOL-



- In order to become an Air Force Pilot – you must go to a college and receive a 4-year college degree (Bachelor's Degree) in any major.
- You must also complete officer training while in college – either through the Air Force Academy or Air Force ROTC.

- **Air Force ROTC** is offered at over 1,100+ schools throughout the country. Air Force ROTC offers scholarships to help pay for school as well. Visit: <https://www.afrotc.com/> for more info.
- **The Air Force Academy** is a highly competitive military service academy. There are no tuition/fees for the Air Force Academy and there are only 1,000 slots for incoming Freshmen. Visit: <https://www.academyadmissions.com/> for more info.



- During your time in Air Force ROTC or at the Air Force Academy – you will compete for a Pilot Slot using: College GPA, Physical Fitness Scores, Leadership Potential, Commander's Ranking, Air Force Officer Qualifying Test, and Flight Hours.
- Upon Graduation from Air Force ROTC or the Air Force Academy – you will commission as a Second Lieutenant in the United States Air Force. Your first assignment will be to attend flight training for the Air Force.

- If you don't yet have your Private Pilot's License (PPL), the Air Force will send you to Initial Flight Training (IFT). IFT is in Pueblo, CO and is a 4-week program for Pilot Trainees where students will fly the DA-20 (pictured right). After completing IFT – Students/Lieutenants will go to Undergraduate Pilot Training (UPT).
- Students/Lieutenants who already have their PPL will skip IFT and go straight to UPT.





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-UNDERGRADUATE PILOT TRAINING (UPT)-



- Undergraduate Pilot Training (UPT) is what you think of when you think of “Flight School.” It consists of 48-52 weeks of 12 hours a day. In flight school, you will be flying daily – sometimes twice a day, have academics, simulator time, and studying.
- There are three primary locations for UPT
 - 1) Laughlin Air Force Base, TX
 - 2) Columbus Air Force Base, MS
 - 3) Vance Air Force Base, OK

For students who are highly competitive for UPT – there is the option to train with our NATO allies through Euro-NATO Joint Jet Pilot Training (ENJJPT). This is highly competitive, for the top 10% of pilot slot applicants, and takes place at Sheppard Air Force, TX.



T-6 Texan II



- The first phase of UPT – every student will fly the T-6 (left). After the first 6 months of UPT – students will either move to the T-1 or the T-38

T-1 Jayhawk



- Those who are selected to continue UPT on the T-1 have been selected for the Airlift/Tanker Track
- Students who complete training in the T-1 will be assigned one of the following aircraft following graduation:

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|---------------|---------------|----------|
| ○ C-5M | ○ HC-130N/P/J | ○ E-3 |
| ○ C-17A | ○ MC-130H/P/J | ○ E-4A |
| ○ C-130H | ○ WC-130J | ○ E-8C |
| ○ EC-130H | ○ KC-10A | ○ C-12 |
| ○ WC-130H | ○ KC-46A | ○ C-21A |
| ○ C-130J | ○ KC-135 | ○ C-144 |
| ○ AC-130U/W/J | ○ RC-135 | ○ C-145 |
| ○ EC-130J/SJ | ○ WC-135 | ○ C-146A |
| | | ○ U-28A |
| | | ○ CV-22B |

T-38 Talon



- Those who are selected to continue UPT on the T-38 have been selected for the Fighter/Bomber Track
- Students who complete training in the T-38 will be assigned one of the following aircraft following graduation:

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|-----------|--------|
| ○ A-10C | ○ F-16 |
| ○ B-1B | ○ F-22 |
| ○ B-2A | ○ F-35 |
| ○ B-52H | ○ U-2 |
| ○ F-15C/D | |
| ○ F-15E | |